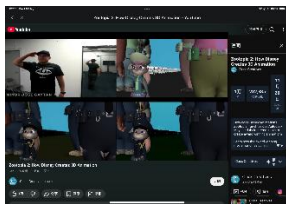


I plan to study animation since I was in Grade 10. I was curious about animation production. It was not until I went to university that I finally had the opportunity to experience animation production.

I used Maya to animate the model. During my level 5 learning, I recorded videos of myself moving as references and then animate them. Honestly, it is easy to get started, but getting high marks is not easy. I often had to think about whether the pose matched the reference video. My routine is to create a keyframe every five minutes. For example, for an animation reference of 200 frames, I would initially create about 40 frames. After that, I would continue creating new keyframes every five frames by following the reference. Having three views to provide a complete perspective helps me with pose calibration even more.



I searched online for various behind-the-scenes vlogs of 3D animation production. I was amazed by the thousands volume of work involved, especially the smooth transitions between character movements. I feel that achieving a high degree of smoothness and naturalness in character movement is a challenge. When creating animation, it is not just about filming yourself moving as a reference. For example, in large-scale commercial films like Zootopia. Disney animators specifically went to the zoo to observe animal behaviour for a natural look and realism. But I can talk about that later... Returning to the animation production process, some provide software screenshots. It is helpful to first find some large-scale movements, use stepping, and then spline them. Afterward, I can create detailed animations based on the visuals. After that, I am learning rigging now. Because the next step after rigging is animation. If there are problems with the controller or the model, I might be able to solve them myself.



Furthermore, I've discovered a stark reality—aside from the animation assignments required by school, I haven't created many additional animations. This is a significant disadvantage for my portfolio... To gain an edge in the job market, I plan to try creating some character animations over the summer, including expressions of emotion, mime, or poses. The process might be a bit tedious—which job isn't? However, I'm looking forward to working for three hours straight with my favourite music playing in the background, and if I'm lucky, gaining some experience—it sounds romantic.

In addition, my friend recommended using UE5 for animation. It seems like the software which focus on games. My plan is to first create a rough animation using Maya, then transfer

the files to UE5 for experimental animation. But the most important thing first is to master some Maya layout techniques, including curve adjustments in the animation editor.

So far, I've uploaded experimental character animations, as well as my level 5 assignments, to my website. I'll also update it as soon as my animal animation is available. I hope that my assets in my Professional Practice assignments, including the website I created and my Art Station profile, won't be treated as one-time projects. They will be continuously updated.

Class Creatives. (2026). Zootopia 2: How Disney Creates 3D Animation. [Video]. Available in <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b3kcbNeDZiw> [Assessed in 3 May 2026]

HasanChen. (2026). 【模型抽象关我动画什么事/花絮/虎特工执勤记【1 分钟动画剧场】-哔哩哔哩】 [Video] <https://b23.tv/kzwjdbg> [Assessed in 7 Aug 2026]